Current Affairs — 13 October

Daily class | Current affairs + Karnataka paper + Monument of the day: Sanchi Stupa + Revision

*English rendering of the Hindi class transcript. Garbled names/figures in the auto-generated transcript are marked **[unclear]** or **[as heard]**. Answer options were on screen (not in the transcript), so Part B gives question → correct answer.*

PART A — TOPIC-WISE NOTES WITH QUICK REVISION

1. Nobel Prize in Economics 2026 (and recap of all Nobels)

- **Winners: Robert Hall and Michael Woodford** (both from the **USA**) — work on the **microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stability** and on making **fiscal and monetary policy** better. Trick: 'Michael goes to the **Hall** to discuss the **macro** (whole-world) economy'. **Macro** = whole world/economy; **micro** = one country.
- Official name: **Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences** (earlier called 'Risk Bank prize' as heard); added as the **6th category in 1968**, first award **1969**; prize money **12 million Kronor**; given by the **Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences**.
- Nobels are in the name of **Alfred Nobel**; presented on **10 December (Human Rights Day)**. Only the **Peace prize** is given by **Norway (Oslo)**; the other five by Swedish bodies. Trick: P → Peace, O → Oslo.
- **Indian economics laureates: Amartya Sen (1998)** (gave India's poverty definition) and **Abhijit Banerjee (2019)**. **2025 Economics:** three winners — **Joel, Philippe and Peter** [as heard].
- **Recap 2026:** Medicine → **NDH**; Chemistry → **CSK** trick (Kagan/Soi as heard); Physics → **PF**; Literature → **Annie (Canada)**; Peace → **Navi Pillay** (Indian origin, South Africa). (Aside: Trump reportedly upset with Norway over the Peace prize.)

⚡ QUICK REVISION

› Economics 2026 → Robert Hall & Michael Woodford (USA) — macroeconomic stability | 12 million Kronor | 6th category 1968, first 1969

› Indians: Amartya Sen 1998, Abhijit Banerjee 2019 | Peace → Norway/Oslo, others → Sweden | Awards on 10 Dec

2. India–Russia: Exercise INDRA 2026 & Defence

- **Exercise INDRA 2026** (**IND**ia + **R**ussi**A**) — **naval exercise** at **Vladivostok, Russia**; **13–18 Oct**; two phases (**Harbour** and **Sea**); first held **2003**. (Moscow = capital; St Petersburg hosted the Tiger Conference 2010 → Global Tiger Day **29 July**.)
- India sent **INS Sahyadri** — **stealth frigate / guided-missile** ship; it is sent to exercises under India's **MAHASAGAR** initiative (launched **2025**) for the Indian & Pacific Ocean regions.
- Russian equipment with India: **MiG-21, Sukhoi, S-400**; future **S-500**. India–Russia **24th summit** was in **Delhi** [as stated]; **Putin** visited India. **AK-203** rifles are made in **Amethi**.
- **ASEAN–India exercise** in the **Philippines** — India sent **INS Kulish**.
- **Exercise Konkan 2026** (India–UK naval): **Plymouth, UK**; **8–15 Oct**; India's **INS Trishul** (stealth frigate); India–UK vision up to **2035**; harbour + sea phase; first held **2004**; **2025** edition on the **Konkan coast** (Maharashtra–Goa), where INS Vikrant took part.
- **MIST** = **Museum of Innovation, Startup and Technology**.
- Aside: protests at **Jantar Mantar** are no longer allowed — **MHA** has defined **three new places** for protest.

⚡ QUICK REVISION

› INDRA 2026 → Vladivostok, 13–18 Oct, INS Sahyadri, first 2003, MAHASAGAR (2025)

› Konkan 2026 → Plymouth (UK), 8–15 Oct, INS Trishul, first 2004 | ASEAN–India (Philippines) → INS Kulish

› MIST = Museum of Innovation, Startup & Technology

3. Navy Ships — Shreyas

- **Shreyas** — **3rd Next-Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel** launched by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders (GRSE), Kolkata**; to be handed to the **Indian Navy**; built in about **5 months**; speed **23 knots**; used for surveillance/patrolling.
- Series of **4**: 1st **Sanghamitra**, 2nd **Shruti**, 3rd **Shreyas**; 4th under construction. 'Shreyas' (Sanskrit) = excellent/best.
- (Earlier in the week: ICG ship Ajit and Navy ship Mangrol were covered on 12 Oct.)

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Shreyas = 3rd NGOPV, GRSE Kolkata, 23 knots | Order: Sanghamitra → Shruti → Shreyas (4 ships)

4. Institutions, Appointments & Polity

- **NHRC** — completed **33 years** on **12 Oct** (founded **1993**); **not a constitutional body**; headed by a former judge — **Justice V. Ramasubramanian**; chief guest **CJI Surya Kant**; theme **'Water, the Nectar of Life'**; held in **Delhi** (topics: climate change, economic inequality, social vulnerability). **UN Human Rights Council** — formed **2006**, HQ **Geneva**, **47** member countries (Navi Pillay worked there).
- **Deputy Election Commissioner: Prakash Rajpurohit** appointed, term till **8 April 2030**, replacing **Sanjay Kumar**. **CEC: Gyanesh Kumar** (protest in Delhi demanding his resignation); **Election Commissioners: Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi**. Total **27 appointments** by the **Appointments Committee** (Ministry of Personnel); **NTA Joint Secretary: Vivek Khare**.
- **ECI facts:** constitutional body; 3 members; term **6 years or 65 years of age**; appointed by the **President**; removal process like **impeachment**; conducts elections of **Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha, Vidhan Sabha, President, Vice-President**.
- **Judicial Well-being Committee** (standing committee for **mental health of judges**, SC/HC) set up by **CJI Surya Kant**; head **Justice K.V. Viswanathan**; framed on **World Mental Health Day (10 Oct)**; idea from a **2024 declaration (Nuru [as heard])**; **5 members**. WMHD theme [as heard]: **'Lived Experience Heard'**; first celebrated **1992**; helpline **Tele-MANAS**.
- **Agencies' establishment year:** CBI **1963**, ED and Anti-Corruption Bureau as listed were correct; CVC statutory Act is **2003** (listed option A, B, C correct).
- **Alkaloid-plant match:** Quinine → Cinchona (malaria), Morphine → Opium poppy, Nicotine → Tobacco, Caffeine → Coffee/Tea — correct option **2**.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› NHRC: 1993, statutory (not constitutional), Justice V. Ramasubramanian, theme 'Water, the Nectar of Life' | UNHRC: 2006, Geneva, 47

› Deputy EC → Prakash Rajpurohit (till 8 Apr 2030) | CEC Gyanesh Kumar | NTA Jt Secy → Vivek Khare

› Judicial Well-being Committee → CJI Surya Kant; head K.V. Viswanathan | WMHD 10 Oct, first 1992

5. Reports & Indices — Global Innovation Index 2026

- **Global Innovation Index 2026** released by **WIPO** (World Intellectual Property Organization, HQ **Geneva**); **19th edition**; **139 economies**; first report **2007**.
- **India: 38th** (rank **81 in 2015 → 66 in 2019 → 38** now). **Top 3: Switzerland (1), Sweden (2), USA (3)**; **China: 10th**. India is **No. 1 among middle-income economies** (heard as among 36 countries) and also No. 1 in the lower-income group [as stated].
- Focus areas: ICT services, patents, innovation, corporate brands, industrial design, trademarks.
- Other rankings recalled: **Travel & Tourism** — India **31**; **HDI (UNDP)** — India **130**; also Happiness Index (often asked).

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› GII 2026 → WIPO (Geneva), 19th ed., 139 economies, India 38 (81 in 2015, 66 in 2019)

› Top 3: Switzerland, Sweden, USA | China 10 | T&T; India 31 | HDI India 130

6. Sports, Awards & People

- **Commonwealth Games (Glasgow):** India finished **4th**; **Mirabai Chanu** and **Lovlina** had roles in the opening, **Jasmine** in the closing; **Manu Bhaker** was **not** given a role there (she was India's **flag-bearer at the Asian Games**).
- **2026 Grand Slam match:** the question asked for the **incorrectly matched** pair — options **B and C** were incorrect (Alexander has not won the Australian Open; he won the US Open as per option D).
- **Smriti Mandhana** appointed **UNICEF India Celebrity Advocate** on **International Day of the Girl Child (11 Oct)**; she is also India women's captain (replaced Harmanpreet Kaur). Campaign: **'Promise to Children'**; she will work for **girls' equality**. Day first observed by **UNGA in 2012**.
- **UNICEF:** HQ **New York**, formed **1946**; full form **United Nations International Children's Emergency Fund**. Other Indian UNICEF faces: Ayushmann Khurrana, Sachin Tendulkar, Kareena Kapoor Khan.
- **Sonia Gandhi's autobiography: 'Belonging: A Journey of Love'** [title as heard].

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› CWG Glasgow → India 4th; Manu Bhaker had no ceremony role | Smriti → UNICEF India Celebrity Advocate (Girl Child Day 11 Oct, 'Promise to Children')

› UNICEF: New York, 1946 | Girl Child Day first 2012

7. Ram Mandir & FSSAI 'Eat Right Place of Worship'

- **FSSAI** gave the **'Eat Right Place of Worship'** certificate to the **Ram Janmabhoomi Mandir, Ayodhya** on the **first day of Navratri**; valid till **10 Oct 2028**. It ensures hygienic, safe, non-wasted **prasad/food** inside temple premises (like canteens at JK Temple, Kanpur).
- **FSSAI:** established **2006**; HQ **Delhi**; under the **Ministry of Health**; portal **FoSCoS** (as heard).
- **Temple facts:** on the **Saryu**, **Uttar Pradesh**; airport named after **Valmiki**; Trust CEO **Jitendra Mishra** [as stated]; built by the **Sompura family**; **Nagara style**; height about **161 ft**; **pink stone**; sanctum (**garbhagriha**) holds the **5-year-old Ram Lalla** idol made by **Arun Yogiraj**.
- Other temples: **Kashi Vishwanath → Varanasi**, **Mahakaleshwar → Ujjain**, **Jagannath → Odisha**.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Eat Right Place of Worship → Ram Mandir, valid till 10 Oct 2028 | FSSAI: 2006, Delhi, Health Ministry

› Ram Mandir: Sompura family, Nagara, 161 ft, pink stone, idol by Arun Yogiraj, airport → Valmiki

8. MONUMENT OF THE DAY — SANCHI STUPA

- **Raisen district, Madhya Pradesh**; **UNESCO World Heritage** since **1989**; dedicated to **Buddhism**; a **stupa** represents death/relics.
- Built in the **3rd century BC** by **Ashoka the Great** (Mauryan period); later additions by **Shunga** and **Satavahana** dynasties. Contains Buddha's teachings and **relics**; art style: **Greco-Buddhist (Gandhara)**.
- **Four gateways (toranas)** — east, west, north, south — carved with Buddha's life stories and **Jataka tales** (also seen in **Ajanta caves**), daily life, animals and nature.
- Structure: dome (**anda**), **harmika** (railed enclosure on top), **chhatra** (umbrella), stone railing **vedika**. **No idol of Buddha** — no idol worship. Picture appears on the **₹200 note**.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Sanchi: Raisen (MP), 3rd c. BC, Ashoka, UNESCO 1989, Buddhism, 4 toranas, Greco-Buddhist art

› Harmika, chhatra, vedika | No Buddha idol | ₹200 note

9. Revision Questions & Announcements

- **Revision:** Nepal flood → Budhi Gandaki; Greenfield No. 1 → India; Bathukamma → Telangana; Ajit → Indian Coast Guard; Bhaginee Nivedita Yojana → West Bengal (to be implemented from **1 Jan 2027**); Project Seabird → Karwar (Karnataka); Adani–Druk 770 MW → Bhutan; AVANI app → IIT Ropar; Mohan Thal → Ambaji Temple (Gujarat); India–NZ U20 Rugby → Rajgir (Bihar).

- **Announcements:** GD result is out; lowest-price offer session on **16 Oct, 6 PM**; a student (**Umanshu**) compiled a PDF of 1–10 Oct current affairs (shared on Telegram); class PDF on Telegram; no UPSC link with the crash course; homework: answer revision questions in comments.

⚡ **QUICK REVISION**

› Homework & revision from 12 Oct topics | 16 Oct 6 PM offer session

PART B — ALL MCQs FROM THE CLASS (Question → Correct Answer)

Question as asked in class → correct answer given by the teacher.

#	Question	Answer
1	INS Sahyadri went to which exercise and where in Russia?	**INDRA 2026 — Vladivostok**
2	First INDRA exercise held in which year? Dates of 2026 edition?	**2003; 13–18 Oct**
3	Full form of MIST?	**Museum of Innovation, Startup and Technology**
4	Nobel Prize in Economics 2026 awarded to?	**Robert Hall & Michael Woodford (USA)**
5	Economics Nobel: which year added / first award / prize money?	**Added 1968; first 1969; 12 million Kronor**
6	Indian economics Nobel laureates and years?	**Amartya Sen (1998), Abhijit Banerjee (2019)**
7	Economics Nobel 2025 winners?	**Joel, Philippe and Peter [as heard]**
8	Which Nobel is awarded by Norway?	**Peace (others by Sweden)**
9	CWG Glasgow — who was NOT given a ceremony role?	**Manu Bhaker**
10	NHRC completed how many years on 12 Oct? Head?	**33 years; Justice V. Ramasubramanian**
11	NHRC foundation-day theme / venue?	**Water, the Nectar of Life; Delhi**
12	UN Human Rights Council — year, HQ, members?	**2006; Geneva; 47**
13	Sonia Gandhi's autobiography?	**Belonging: A Journey of Love**
14	FSSAI 'Eat Right Place of Worship' certificate given to?	**Ram Janmabhoomi Mandir, Ayodhya**
15	Incorrectly matched Grand Slam 2026 winners?	**B and C**
16	Deputy Election Commissioner appointed (term till 2030)?	**Prakash Rajpurohit**
17	NTA Joint Secretary appointed?	**Vivek Khare**
18	Alkaloid–plant match (quinine, morphine, nicotine, caffeine)?	**Option 2**
19	Judicial Well-being Committee head? Formed by?	**Justice K.V. Viswanathan; CJI Surya Kant**
20	Which agencies' establishment years matched correctly?	**A, B, C (CVC Act is 2003)**
21	Global Innovation Index 2026 — issuing body, edition, India's rank?	**WIPO; 19th; 38th**
22	GII 2026 — Top 3 and China's rank?	**Switzerland, Sweden, USA; China 10th**
23	3rd Next-Gen Offshore Patrol Vessel for Navy?	**Shreyas (GRSE, Kolkata)**
24	UNICEF India Celebrity Advocate (Girl Child Day)?	**Smriti Mandhana ('Promise to Children')**
25	Exercise Konkan 2026 (India–UK) held at?	**Plymouth, UK (INS Trishul)**
26	Sanchi Stupa — built by? Location? UNESCO year?	**Ashoka (3rd c. BC); Raisen, MP; 1989**
27	Nepal flood river (revision)?	**Budhi Gandaki**
28	Greenfield investment No. 1 (revision)?	**India**
29	Bhaginee Nivedita Yojana state / start date (revision)?	**West Bengal; 1 Jan 2027**
30	Project Seabird base (revision)?	**Karwar, Karnataka**